

Industry News

Global OLED market up by 35 per cent

Market research company DisplaySearch has reported that the revenues for organic light-emitting diodes (OLEDs) shot up by 35 per cent in 2009 to \$828 million. An increased active-matrix OLEDs (AMOLEDs) demand for the main display of mobile phones was the key driver of the growth.

The increased demand for AMOLEDs also led to it overtaking passive-matrix OLED (PMOLED) revenues for the first time, with \$537 million in annual revenue compared to PMOLED revenues of \$291 million. Demand for PMOLEDs fell as a result of mobile phones shifting from clamshell designs, which use PMOLEDs for secondary displays, to smart phones, which use larger active-matrix displays.

"We expect AMOLED revenue growth to remain strong in 2010. In order for PMOLEDs to make a comeback, the technology needs to be developed for new applications such as automotive and consumer electronics that are currently adopting PMLCD," said Hiroshi Hayase, an analyst with DisplaySearch.

Semiconductor manufacturing spending dropped almost by half

Worldwide semiconductor capital equipment spending totaled \$16.6 billion in 2009—a 45.8 per cent decline from 2008. In major segments, wafer fab equipment declined 47 per cent, while back-end equipment decreased 40 per cent, as both areas were hit hard by reductions in capital spending.

Said Dean Freeman, research vice president for Gartner's semiconductor manufacturing research group, "By

the end of the year, the major companies resumed spending, with a focus on implanting the latest technology throughout their organisations. We expect this trend to continue in 2010, with technology upgrades accounting for the majority of spending—at least through the first half of the year."

Despite a 38 per cent decline in revenue in 2009, Applied Materials increased its worldwide market share to 15.1 per cent (up from 13.2 per cent in 2008). Tokyo Electron returned to No. 2 position for semiconductor equipment, overtaking ASML.

India to become biggest DTH market

The number of direct-to-home (DTH) subscribers is swelling in India, and by 2012, the country will become the largest DTH market in the world, overtaking the US, according to a study by Media Partners Asia (MPA). The number of Indian DTH subscribers will reach 58 million by 2020, up from 45 million by 2014, from a net installed base of 17 million in 2009.



In Focus

Manglik appointed NASSCOM chairman

National Association of Software and Services Companies (NASSCOM) has appointed Harsh Manglik as the new chairman of its executive council for the year 2010-2011.

Manglik, who succeeds Pramod Bhasin, chairman for the year 2009-10, has been a member of NASSCOM's executive council and is currently the chairman and geography managing director for Accenture in India.

Most DTH satellite pay-TV operators will start making money after 2013. Pay-TV penetration will grow to more than 90 per cent in the long-term from 78 per cent in 2009.

Cable will retain 70 per cent market share by 2014, falling to 64 per cent by 2020, while DTH will scale up to almost 35 per cent.

Staff hiring to boost PC sales

Sales of PCs in India will increase substantially this year. The factors driving this growth will be brisk manpower addition, especially in the IT/ITes sector, PC refresh cycle at enterprises and government buying (especially for e-governance projects across the country). National Association of Software and Services Companies (NASSCOM) predicts a staff addition of 150,000 this year.

While the developed countries witnessed sharp job cuts in 2008 and 2009, the impact wasn't too deep on India's IT/ITes sector. In fact, with recovery